

Magic Quadrant for Business Orchestration and Automation Technologies

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Business orchestration and automation technology platforms unify process orchestration, connectivity and agentic features to enable enterprisewide automation. This Magic Quadrant assesses 20 BOAT vendors to help guide your business process automation decisions.

Strategic Planning Assumption

By 2030, 70% of enterprises will pivot to a consolidated automation platform that orchestrates business processes, AI agents, bots, APIs and human actions, up from 10% today.

Market Definition/Description

Gartner defines business orchestration and automation technologies (BOAT) as a consolidated software platform that orchestrates and automates disparate business processes and tasks with varying degrees of autonomy and complexity across enterprise systems. A BOAT platform must provide native capabilities for AI agents' orchestration and governance and multiagent coordination. It must leverage a combination of native connectivity methods, such as model context protocol, API and UI interactions, enabling secure, end-to-end enterprise agentic process automation across diverse execution environments.

A BOAT platform would be suitable for those who are looking to enable agentic automation by consolidating traditional deterministic automation with emerging probabilistic agentic capabilities. Such a platform should be used to address a wide range of business process automation use cases within the enterprise, such as:

- Case management with intelligent knowledge agents.
- Complex long-running workflows.
- Multivendor AI agents' coordination and governance.
- Task automation (deterministic and nondeterministic).
- Universal orchestration (AI agents, humans, bots and other tools).

Customers typically looking to buy or blend process automation and orchestration instead of custom-building may prefer a BOAT platform. Organizations might also end up with more than one BOAT platform, depending on their needs.

Mandatory Features

- AI agent orchestration, governance, life cycle management and multiagent coordination
- Agent interoperability (e.g., MCP, A2A)
- Agent and tool registry, RAG
- Long-running, stateful process orchestration
- API- and event-driven connectivity
- Ability to design, build and deploy AI agents, workflows, connectors and tools
- Human task emulation via “computer use”
- Low-code development, business-IT collaboration, and platform governance, security and operations

Optional Features

- Process design and modeling with interoperable standards (e.g., BPMN 2.0 or DMN)
- Data management and storage
- Human task emulation via RPA

- Extraction of data from unstructured and semistructured documents
- Support for domain-specific models, sovereign models, proprietary frontier models and SLMs for AI agents
- LLM orchestration
- Observability and reporting
- Traditional AI/ML features
- AI-assisted development
- Process discovery and monitoring

Magic Quadrant

Figure 1: Magic Quadrant for Business Orchestration and Automation Technologies



Magic Quadrant for Business Orchestration and Automation Technologies



Gartner

Vendor Strengths and Cautions

Amazon Web Services

Amazon Web Services (AWS) is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company with global operations serving customers in a wide range of industries, primarily financial services, healthcare and manufacturing.

Amazon Web Services' BOAT is the Amazon Quick platform, which combines process automation, business intelligence (BI) and agentic AI in a single managed-service runtime. Top

features include a multiagent architecture for planning and execution, UI agents and an enterprise knowledge graph for context.

The BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of agent evaluations, an enterprise knowledge graph desktop for local contextual AI and autonomous digital teammates for cross-system execution.

Strengths

- **Comprehensive pricing:** AWS adopts a dual-structured commercial model, pairing standard per-user platform subscriptions with a fixed, consumption-focused hourly rate for agent runtime. A key advantage of this model is that the vendor directly absorbs all foundation model inference expenses into the hourly rate; consequently, customers avoid separate charges for API calls or large language model (LLM) tokens, eliminating separate billing for these components, though an Amazon Quick license remains required for automation authors.
- **AI agent interoperability:** AWS enables interoperability by natively embedding open standards like the Model Context Protocol (MCP) and Agent2Agent (A2A) networking protocol. This enables customers to dynamically discover, integrate and invoke third-party tools and external agents without requiring custom API development. AWS delivers this interoperability while natively maintaining strict enterprise governance, role-based access control (RBAC) and auditability through AWS CloudTrail and AWS IAM Identity Center.
- **Agentic automation:** AWS differentiates Quick Automate with a multiagent architecture that combines deterministic workflow, AI agents, UI interaction, case management and human-in-the-loop execution. It can also incorporate custom agents from Amazon Bedrock, Bedrock AgentCore and third-party platforms for complex end-to-end automation.

Cautions

- **Nascent product:** Amazon Quick launched in October 2025, making it the most recently launched solution evaluated among all vendors in this report. Many of its more advanced case management and process orchestration capabilities in Quick Automate are unproven compared with more established automation vendors. Organizations planning large-scale business orchestration initiatives should validate production references and roadmap maturity for advanced orchestration scenarios.

- **Commercial packaging:** Quick Automate is available as part of Amazon Quick’s Enterprise plan rather than as a stand-alone automation offering. Buyers primarily seeking BOAT capabilities should assess whether the broader Quick bundle, per-user pricing and infrastructure charges align with their automation requirements and expected usage.
- **Deployment flexibility:** Amazon Quick is delivered as an AWS-managed cloud service and is available in seven AWS Regions spanning North America, Europe and Asia/Pacific (APAC) — including U.S. East (Northern Virginia), U.S. West (Oregon), Europe (Dublin, London, Frankfurt) and APAC (Tokyo, Sydney). Organizations requiring on-premises or sovereign deployment models should validate regional availability and deployment options against their enterprise requirements.

Appian

Appian is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers with presence primarily in North America and Europe. Its top industries are financial services, government and life sciences.

Appian’s BOAT is the Appian Platform, which combines low-code application development, robotic process automation (RPA) and intelligent document processing (IDP). Top features include a unified data fabric, AI agents embedded within deterministic workflows and Appian Autoscale for dynamic scaling without manual intervention.

The vendor’s BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of the Agent Command Center for cross-system observability and enhancement of its current support for agent orchestration with the open Agent2Agent protocol.

Strengths

- **Mature automation platform:** The platform natively consolidates workflows, robotic process automation, document processing and AI agents into a single engine. Appian supports both Business Process Model and Notation (BPMN) and Decision Model and Notation (DMN) to enable a model-driven approach to process orchestration. Appian’s unified approach and process experience enables IT to securely scale complex, highly regulated enterprise operations.
- **Unified enterprise data fabric:** Appian leverages its data fabric as the central context layer for agentic context setup. This enforces comprehensive security for tables, columns, rows and actions.

- **Partner ecosystem:** Over the last several years, Appian tiered its partner program to focus on the strongest delivery partners. This strategy contrasts from the majority of evaluated vendors that oversaw increasing partner programs.

Cautions

- **Vendor lock-in:** Appian customers report feeling constrained by the platform, citing high migration expenses and monolithic architecture. This leads some customers to perceive themselves as locked into the Appian ecosystem, lacking straightforward and affordable alternatives for transitioning away.
- **Citizen-developer friction:** Appian prioritizes strict deterministic control over decentralized, business-led application generation. This strategic trade-off actively restricts the freedom of general-purpose citizen developers. Appian's priority is to provide IT with rapid development and vibe-coding tools in managed environments, so organizations prioritizing broad vibe coding may find Appian's technical developer focus rigid and restricting.
- **Budgeting complexity:** Appian's multivariable commercial model combines fixed and usage-based fee structures, creating forecasting challenges for procurement teams estimating total cost of ownership (TCO) across enterprise deployments.

Automation Anywhere

Automation Anywhere is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving a broad range of customers worldwide, supported by engineering and support centers in North America and India. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and telecommunications.

Automation Anywhere's BOAT is the Automation 360 platform, which combines AI agents, RPA bots, APIs, document extraction and human tasks in a cloud-native orchestration layer. Top features include the Mozart Orchestrator for universal coordination, the Process Reasoning Engine (PRE) with contextual intelligence, governance, observability and packaged agentic solutions.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for next year includes general availability of the Context Intelligence Graph for continuous learning, Automation Anywhere Code for natural language process generation and intelligent EnterpriseClaw agents.

Strengths

- **Automation heritage:** Automation Anywhere has extensive enterprise experience delivering large-scale automation initiatives. Organizations with mature RPA programs can leverage existing investments while gradually expanding toward broader AI-enabled orchestration.
- **Platform features:** Automation 360's use of the open MCP enables seamless bidirectional AI-agent orchestration. Its native data-masking and tokenization guardrails automatically secure sensitive information before LLM model calls. It handles complex and legacy interfaces through UI automation powered by the Universal Recorder and AISense computer vision.
- **AI agent governance:** The platform provides an agentic control plane to manage identity, strict role-based access and life cycle policies. It supports sovereign models to ensure data residency compliance. These governance capabilities, identity controls and AI agent oversight features support organizations operating in regulated industries that require centralized management of automation assets.

Cautions

- **Process orchestration:** Despite the launch of Mozart Orchestrator for process orchestration, adoption by end customers remains unproven. Although Automation Anywhere demonstrates strong technical flow coordination workflows, support for case management process complexity is evolving.
- **BOAT visibility:** Despite investments in Mozart Orchestrator, PRE and agent interoperability, Automation Anywhere has yet to establish a larger market presence with its BOAT as an enterprise agent control plane. Gartner client inquiries on agent orchestration and control planes indicate that few currently identify Automation Anywhere as a strategic platform choice.
- **Compliance and certification gaps:** Automation Anywhere currently lacks key public-sector and industry security authorizations, specifically FedRAMP, FISMA, PCI DSS and the U.K. Government-Cloud (G-Cloud) certification. This absence can restrict its deployment in federal and public sector environments that strictly mandate these standards.

Bizagi

Bizagi is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company with strong presence in Latin America and Europe. It serves midmarket customers in industries such as financial

services, the public sector and manufacturing.

Bizagi's BOAT is the Enterprise Automation Platform, which combines people, systems, data, business rules and AI agents in one end-to-end process execution runtime. Top features include AI orchestration with dynamic autonomy modes, Bizagi Maker for AI-assisted design and AI Workers for human task prework.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of componentized AI-assisted design within Bizagi Studio, the continued expansion of Bizagi Maker for creating agentic orchestrations and expanded agent memory services for long-running context.

Strengths

- **AI-driven design capabilities:** Bizagi offers intuitive process modeling and AI-assisted design capabilities. The platform offers an AI-assisted designer that uses natural language to guide users through generating data models, rules and complete process flows. This reduces development time significantly and empowers business users to build orchestration solutions safely.
- **Predictable pricing:** Bizagi's consumption-based commercial model tied to performance units directly links automation expenditures to quantifiable business outcomes. By eliminating the friction associated with volatile per-seat licensing, it enables organizations to initiate deployments on a small scale and expand dynamically as needed.
- **Case management:** The platform blends process models and virtualized data with dynamic case management for unstructured workflows. This ensures robust state persistence across complex business processes. Humans and AI agents can securely collaborate on exception-heavy tasks in regulated sectors.

Cautions

- **Agent management:** The vendor has not committed to a timeline for native support of open cross-ecosystem A2A protocols. The vendor also lacks expanded memory services and native integration with third-party observability tools, leaving external monitoring as a future roadmap item.
- **Platform operations:** Bizagi misses built-in approval workflows to securely govern deployment pipelines. Moreover, the absence of native project planning and ROI tracking forces IT teams to rely on external tools to measure automation success.

- **Market focus and scale:** The vendor has adjusted its target buyer demographic to emphasize midmarket entities, with expansion primarily focused within distinct locations including North America, Brazil and South Africa. Large and enterprise customers needing extensive international partner networks may find this specialized, localized approach restrictive.

Boomi

Boomi is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving a broad range of customers worldwide, with primary support in North America, Europe and APAC. Its top industries are manufacturing, retail and financial services.

Boomi's BOAT is the Boomi Enterprise Platform, which combines integration, workflow, data and agentic AI in a single orchestration control plane. Top features include Boomi Orchestrate for end-to-end execution, Agentstudio for full agent life cycle management and Meta Hub for trusted master data context.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of autonomous multiagent hierarchical orchestration, Knowledge Hub for native vector-based enterprise RAG, and a unified, containerized common runtime framework.

Strengths

- **Integration foundation:** Boomi's long-established integration platform provides organizations with a strong foundation for orchestrating applications, APIs and data across hybrid environments, reducing integration effort for automation initiatives. The platform circumvents vendor lock-in for buyers by providing hundreds of prebuilt connectors and acting as an indigenous MCP server for compliant AI agents, allowing external tools to interact securely.
- **Enterprise scale and viability:** The platform demonstrates strong operational resiliency by processing billions of monthly events. It backs its managed cloud infrastructure with a rigorous service-level agreement backed by financial guarantees/penalties. This proven enterprise reliability inspires buyer confidence.
- **AI agent governance:** The platform delivers a centralized registry that governs both native and external third-party AI agents. It natively enforces strict access policies, audit logging and runtime kill switches. This helps organizations maintain regulatory compliance.

Cautions

- **Platform architecture:** Boomi's expanded automation portfolio uses multiple execution engines across integration, workflow, RPA and agentic capabilities. A fully consolidated runtime is still on its roadmap. Buyers need to assess operational complexity, governance and consistency across workloads.
- **BOAT adoption:** Boomi rarely appears as a first-choice discussion for process automation, based on Gartner client inquiries and public sources. While holding strong adjacent capabilities, its unified BOAT offering remains less proven. Organizations seeking deep business process orchestration capabilities should evaluate Boomi's orchestration depth for complex human-centric processes.
- **BOAT breadth:** Despite marketing a new platform, Boomi remains rooted in its core integration and data orchestration identity. It lacks complex process orchestration maturity when compared with business process automation (BPA) heritage BOATs. Native desktop automation is missing, necessitating reliance on third-party partners.

Camunda

Camunda is a Visionary in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving customers primarily in North America, Europe and APAC. Its top industries are financial services, insurance and logistics.

Camunda's BOAT is the Camunda platform, which combines APIs, RPA, human tasks and AI agents in a highly scalable, distributed control plane. Top features include the Zeebe engine for high-throughput execution, BPMN ad hoc subprocesses for Camunda-built AI agents and comprehensive observability via Camunda Operate.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of ProcessOS as an AI-powered process intelligence layer, Camunda Hub for multicloud enterprise governance and a vendor-neutral AI-native developer experience.

Strengths

- **Process orchestration breadth:** Camunda has demonstrated strong adoption by organizations orchestrating complex, long-running, cross-domain business processes and distributed applications. Enterprises with sophisticated orchestration requirements may benefit from its proven execution engine and support for large-scale, event-driven architectures.

- **Open architecture:** Camunda's open architecture minimizes vendor lock-in by leveraging industry standards across the stack. It embraces the process front with native BPMN support, ensuring portable process models, while simultaneously standardizing the agent connectivity layer via MCP. This dual focus allows organizations to enable a modular architecture using Camunda at the core.
- **Partnership ecosystem:** Camunda partners with major system integrators to deliver co-built solutions. This network delivers broad partner reach and trained specialists so customers can kick off initiatives from proven foundations.

Cautions

- **Platform complexity:** Camunda's developer-centric, engine-first architecture prioritizes back-end workflow execution over native user interface design. Building complex, dynamic front-end portals requires IT teams to construct custom interfaces externally and connect them via APIs.
- **Business user adoption:** While BPMN remains a widely adopted standard, organizations without existing process-modeling expertise should anticipate training and governance investments to maximize long-term platform adoption.
- **Camunda 7 to 8 migration complexity:** Gartner clients frequently mention that moving from Camunda 7 to Camunda 8 is not a simple version upgrade, but a fundamental architectural migration. Because Camunda 8 completely replaces Camunda 7's relational database-backed engine with the cloud-native distributed Zeebe orchestration engine, migrating requires organizations to rearchitect how their processes run.

Flowable

Flowable is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving customers primarily in Europe and North America. Its top industries are banking, insurance and healthcare.

Flowable's BOAT is the Flowable Agentic Case Platform, which combines process automation, adaptive case management, decisioning and AI governance in a single runtime built on open standards (BPMN, CMMN, DMN). Top features include model-driven agentic orchestration via Case Management Model and Notation (CMMN), specialized native AI agents for document and utility tasks, and built-in AI agent governance controls.

Over the next 12 months, Flowable plans major improvements to its AI generation of business models, adding a self-verification loop so the AI builds, tests and refines new and existing models autonomously while business users review and sign off. It also plans to add an experience layer delivering the apps in Flowable Work, or as custom apps or headless, or inside Copilot and Teams.

Strengths

- **Process orchestration:** Flowable natively integrates process automation, case management (CMMN), AI agents and decisioning (DMN) into a single execution engine. This architecture allows organizations to coordinate deterministic workflows, human tasks and AI agents within a single, auditable framework.
- **AI agent governance:** Flowable provides a dedicated agent timeline that captures per-run request and response details, token consumption and knowledge base citations. This offers operators deep visibility into AI decision making, satisfying strict regulatory requirements for explainability. Additionally, the platform utilizes an integration layer that allows organizations to bring their own models and dynamically configure them per agent, thus offering more flexibility.
- **Pricing model:** The vendor provides subscription options combining user-based and consumption-based metrics. Organizations can scale AI agent usage without facing unpredictable token-based billing. This allows buyers to align automation costs directly with value.

Cautions

- **Product features:** The platform lacks native computer use agents to navigate legacy desktop interfaces. It relies on external partnerships for these capabilities. This forces IT buyers to manage disparate execution runtimes. The platform also currently lacks industry compliance certifications including FedRAMP, HIPAA and PCI DSS.
- **Sales execution:** The vendor concentrates its direct sales and operational presence predominantly within the European market and North America. Regions like APAC and Latin America rely almost entirely on reseller channels. Global enterprises may struggle to secure consistent support across regions.
- **Market visibility:** Flowable is not well-known in the BOAT market and currently has a relatively smaller user base. Buyers may experience a smaller ecosystem of peer

references, fewer independent user communities and a heavier reliance on specialized system integrators for deployment and local support.

IBM

IBM is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers with a strong presence globally. Its top industries are financial services, insurance and the public sector.

IBM's BOAT consists of multiple products, including the IBM Cloud Pak for Business Automation and watsonx Orchestrate, which combine process management, RPA and AI agents with IBM Bob for agentic development. Top features include the watsonx Orchestrate Agent Catalog and AI Gateway, and the AI-based development through IBM Bob.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of a simplified AI copilot design canvas, an integrated AI model gateway for domain-specific LLMs and a multiagent orchestration control plane for external agents.

Strengths

- **Agentic governance and interoperability:** IBM leverages an external tool alongside watsonx Orchestrate to monitor and secure AI deployments. It natively enforces strict role-based access, data privacy policies and audit logging. This approach to risk management underlines IBM's strength for highly regulated industries. The platform uses open A2A protocols and the MCP framework to coordinate external AI systems.
- **Process orchestration depth:** With its focus on deterministic orchestration driven by open standards of BPMN 2.0, IBM's approach allows business and technical users to deliver solutions in a common language while providing clear graphical auditability for regulatory and compliance purposes.
- **Robust enterprise viability and scale:** Backed by global operations, the vendor demonstrates financial stability and market commitment. Its own system integrators, as well as its wide partner network of global system integrators, provide specialized delivery capacity. This helps to enable resilient execution for complex IT transformations.

Cautions

- **Fragmented BOAT:** Managing the platform requires navigating multiple distinct administrative consoles and operating within a three-layer architecture. This fragmented

backend and execution environment create a steep learning curve, introduce technical overhead, and significantly slow down the deployment and life cycle management of AI solutions. Additionally, the architecture's dependency on Red Hat OpenShift containers for the on-premises version imposes infrastructure requirements. SaaS is available as an alternative lightweight deployment option.

- **Service dependencies:** On-premises platform deployments are complex, services-driven engagements that typically span 10 to 24 weeks. IT buyers must rely on internal consulting or global system integrators to realize value.
- **Complex pricing model:** The commercial model blends legacy user subscriptions with complex point-based consumption metrics. The combination of different metrics can add complexity when evaluating granular unit economics. Enterprise teams will struggle to accurately forecast AI automation costs across the IT portfolio.

Mendix

Mendix is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is an entity within Siemens AG serving a broad range of customers primarily in Europe, North America and APAC. Its top industries are manufacturing, financial services and the public sector.

Mendix's BOAT is the Mendix Platform, which combines a knowledge graph, AI modeling, agentic applications and process orchestration in a unified, governed runtime. Top features include Graph Studio for enterprise context ontologies, AI Studio for custom machine learning and native agentic workflow orchestration.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes Agent Client Protocol support for Studio Pro to host external tools like Claude Code natively in Studio Pro, headless Studio Pro for AI-assisted development, bring-your-own LLMs for Maia and enhanced fleet management governance for AI agents.

Strengths

- **Low-code automation platform:** Mendix combines low-code application development and agent building with workflow and automation in one platform. Buyers can modernize applications while embedding processes and AI into the user experience, reducing the need to assemble separate development and automation tools.
- **Flexible enterprise deployment:** The vendor offers deployment flexibility, including managed cloud, hybrid and fully air-gapped on-premises environments. This allows

regulated enterprises to deploy sovereign AI models securely. It ensures data compliance for mission-critical IT workloads.

- **Siemens ecosystem:** Mendix benefits from Siemens' industrial expertise and ecosystem, particularly across manufacturing and engineering. Buyers with significant Siemens investments can use this alignment to connect applications and workflows more closely with operational environments and industrial transformation initiatives.

Cautions

- **Complex process orchestration:** Mendix supports process orchestration and an expanding set of BPMN patterns, but its approach remains more application-centric than specialist enterprise process platforms. Some BPMN patterns are implemented through broader Mendix platform constructs rather than workflow-native elements. Buyers requiring extensive cross-enterprise process modeling, case management or complex orchestration requirements should validate fit against their requirements.
- **Developer-oriented platform:** Mendix provides visual low-code development, but advanced orchestration frequently combines workflows with Studio Pro constructs such as microflows, domain models and integrations. Organizations seeking extensive business-user-led process design and orchestration should assess the level of developer involvement required for their use cases.
- **AI agent governance:** Mendix is adding AI and agentic capabilities, but enterprisewide orchestration and governance of heterogeneous agents remain evolving areas. A dedicated gateway to securely catalog and govern third-party AI agents behind a single control plane is a near-term roadmap item. The platform lacks centralized multivendor agent monitoring. Immediate and severe policy enforcement gaps are evident when scaling the platform.

Microsoft

Microsoft is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers and has a strong presence globally. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and retail.

Microsoft's BOAT consists of Power Platform and the Azure ecosystem. This primarily includes Microsoft Power Automate, Copilot Studio, Logic Apps and Microsoft Foundry (which enables cloud flows), RPA, data management, and AI agents in a comprehensive Azure cloud

ecosystem. Top features include Copilot Studio for generative AI agent creation and Power Automate for moderate workflow orchestration.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of enhanced autonomous agent capabilities, deeper Copilot integration across the enterprise workspace and expanded AI governance features for centralized control.

Microsoft declined requests for supplemental information. Gartner's analysis is therefore based on other credible sources.

Strengths

- **AI agent control plane:** Microsoft's BOAT strategy provides control planes through Agent 365 and Foundry Control Plane integrated with Entra, Purview and Defender to offer enterprisewide agent inventory, identity, access and policy controls, runtime observability, and evaluation, providing buyers a strong foundation for governing agentic automation at scale.
- **Governance and scalability:** Microsoft combines Power Platform and Microsoft 365 administration with environment controls, security, compliance and life cycle controls to govern automation and AI agents. Its integrated governance across supported Microsoft environments involving agents, connectors and data is particularly valuable for organizations invested in the Microsoft ecosystem.
- **Microsoft ecosystem:** Microsoft leverages its infrastructure and partner network to deliver solutions and support across the globe. Its broad reach ensures access to local expertise and resources, enabling tailored implementations. Customers benefit from reliable support and the flexibility to address region-specific needs, accelerating automation rollouts.

Cautions

- **BOAT fragmentation:** Microsoft lacks the vision for a unified BOAT offering, requiring clients to assemble additional Microsoft solutions, including Power Automate, Azure Logic Apps, Copilot Studio and various Azure services, across its ecosystem. Although Microsoft supports shared foundations such as connectors, Dataverse and Power Platform administration, complex cross-platform requirements may require additional Microsoft services, architecture decisions and operational coordination.
- **Process orchestration adoption:** Customer evidence for using Microsoft's BOAT capabilities to orchestrate highly complex, long-running, end-to-end business processes

remains comparatively limited relative to other established BOAT vendors. Buyers with these requirements should validate relevant production references and proven orchestration scale.

- **Agent governance:** Microsoft is rapidly expanding agent governance and interoperability across Foundry, Azure API Management and Power Platform, but several capabilities for governing MCP tools and cross-agent interactions remain relatively new or in preview. Buyers should validate production readiness and the operational complexity for large-scale agentic orchestration.

n8n

n8n is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving a broad range of customers centered around Europe but growing into the Americas and APAC. Its top industries are technology, financial services and healthcare.

n8n's BOAT is the n8n platform, which combines integration, point AI tools and scripts in a single source-available runtime. Top features include the AI Workflow Builder for prompt-based generation, universal code nodes for combined low-code and pro-code and native MCP integration.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of an advanced automated evaluation framework, direct process design document (PDD)-to-workflow AI generation and native A2A protocol communication support.

Strengths

- **Strong developer mindshare:** With over 200,000 GitHub stars, n8n commands strong developer mindshare. This highly active community drives organic IT adoption globally and empowers enterprise fusion teams with thousands of community templates.
- **Agentic interoperability:** The architecture embraces bidirectional MCP server and client nodes natively out of the box. This allows external AI models to seamlessly discover and trigger internal workflows as governed tools. It prevents AI ecosystem lock-in for enterprise IT buyers.
- **Strategic alignment with SAP:** SAP's strategic investment in n8n and planned embedding of n8n as a fully managed environment within Joule Studio expand its reach into SAP-centric enterprises. The integration enables developers to orchestrate AI agents and

workflows across SAP and non-SAP systems while using SAP-managed identity and operations.

Cautions

- **Process orchestration depth:** n8n supports long-running workflows, human-in-the-loop steps, error handling and reusable subworkflows. However, organizations requiring sophisticated process management constructs should assess its capabilities against their requirements for complex state management, exception handling and long-running process orchestration.
- **Application life cycle management:** n8n provides Git-based source control and environments, but its application life cycle management remains less integrated than that of more mature enterprise automation platforms. Promotion across development and production environments uses a push/pull model across n8n instances and Git branches, and automated deployment can require external tooling. Organizations operating large business-critical automation estates should evaluate the additional governance and operational processes required for controlled testing, promotion and release management.
- **Scalability and resilience:** n8n supports horizontal scaling and high availability through queue mode and multimain deployment. Its multimain architecture uses leader election for at-most-once tasks and requires shared PostgreSQL and Redis infrastructure, adding deployment complexity for enterprise-scale environments.

Nintex

Nintex is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company with a global presence serving a broad range of customers. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and manufacturing.

Nintex's BOAT is the Nintex Agentic Business Orchestration Platform, which combines workflows, forms, document automation and AI agents in a unified cloud execution model. Top features include Nintex Agent Designer for reasoning agents, Nintex Orchestration for blending agentic and deterministic logic, and Nintex Insights.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of a single operational hub to monitor agentic workflows, advanced agents with built-in connectivity to external platforms and a comprehensive agent governance framework.

Strengths

- **Midmarket value:** Nintex enables midmarket organizations to achieve faster operational outcomes through a low-complexity, highly accessible platform. By streamlining the automation experience, Nintex provides a leaner alternative to heavier, complex megavendor solutions, facilitating more efficient IT deployments.
- **Extensive prebuilt connectivity:** The platform natively provides over 80 prebuilt connectors to major enterprise systems alongside low-code options. This minimizes custom IT development overhead for enterprise buyers.
- **Concurrent execution scale:** The platform dynamically scales to handle high volumes of concurrent workflows without hard limitations. It utilizes built-in throttling and queueing to protect downstream systems from overloads. Nintex also offers a robust set of enterprise-grade connectors with the ability to build custom connectors. It also includes API management, event support and an on-premises gateway, which enable resilient enterprise IT operations.

Cautions

- **Platform breadth:** Nintex's BOAT capabilities span cloud and on-premises environments with distinct runtimes across workflows, agents and robots. Some enterprise capabilities, including A2A interoperability, third-party AI orchestration and computer-use agents, remain less mature or unavailable. Furthermore, the platform lacks CI/CD integrations and native security certifications including HIPAA, PCI DSS and NIST.
- **Agentic AI maturity:** Nintex provides AI-assisted workflow and process development alongside Nintex agents. However, several advanced agentic capabilities remain comparatively nascent or roadmap-oriented, including cross-vendor A2A interoperability and advanced evaluation capabilities. Buyers should assess production maturity for complex agentic deployments.
- **Process orchestration split:** Nintex CE is mostly adopted by customers in moderate complexity workflow and document-centric automation, but more complex orchestration use cases are concentrated in K2. Buyers standardizing across cloud and on-premises environments should assess portability, operational consistency and life cycle management across the two environments.

OutSystems

OutSystems is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving a broad range of customers in North America, EMEA and APAC. Its top industries are banking, insurance and the public sector.

OutSystems' BOAT is the OutSystems Agentic Systems Platform, which combines APIs, microservices, human tasks, workflows and AI agents in a cloud-native orchestrated runtime. Top features include the Enterprise Context Graph for deterministic grounding, the Agent Workbench Harness for runtime orchestration and the OutSystems Developer Cloud (ODC) Agent Gateway for governance.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of a native MCP gateway for universal governance, the Institutional Brain for mining conversational intent into workflows, and native RPA and computer use capabilities.

Strengths

- **Low-code automation:** OutSystems combines low-code development with workflow, integration and AI agents to modernize legacy and customer-facing applications. Buyers can replace aging applications while embedding automation into new digital experiences, reducing dependence on fragmented development tools.
- **Developer productivity:** OutSystems combines visual development, reusable components and AI-assisted development to accelerate application delivery. Buyers can enable professional developers to build and change enterprise applications faster while retaining centralized governance, security and life cycle controls.
- **Partner ecosystem:** OutSystems maintains a global ecosystem of certified system integrator partners across multiple regions. These strategic alliances co-sell the platform and deliver industry-specific blueprints and accelerators in areas such as banking, insurance, manufacturing and the public sector.

Cautions

- **Process orchestration:** OutSystems supports workflow within applications but is less specialized for complex, cross-enterprise process orchestration. Buyers requiring advanced process modeling and complex long-running workflows should assess whether complementary business process management (BPM) or orchestration tools are needed.
- **Commercial investment:** OutSystems is typically positioned and priced as a strategic enterprise development platform. Buyers extending it broadly into automation should

model licensing and operating costs as applications, users and workloads scale, particularly where simpler automation tools could address lower-complexity use cases.

- **Business-user accessibility:** OutSystems primarily targets professional development teams rather than broad citizen-led automation. Buyers seeking business users to independently build workflows and automations may require greater IT support, training and governance, potentially limiting adoption outside application development teams.

Pega

Pega is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company with a global presence, serving a broad range of customers. Its top industries are financial services, insurance and telecommunications.

Pega's BOAT is the Pega Infinity platform, which combines workflows, data, agentic AI, APIs and human interactions in orchestration runtime. Top features include Pega Blueprint for workflow architecture design, Pega Agentic Process Fabric and Pega GenAI Automate for intelligent workflow execution.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of a rationalized Infinity Studio authoring experience, native bring-your-own integrated development environment (IDE) support for agentic development and agentic master data management for data unification.

Strengths

- **Enterprise-grade BOAT:** Pega provides unified orchestration across processes, decisions and AI agents, supporting complex stateful workflows and exceptions. Security and certifications, including FedRAMP High, HIPAA and PCI DSS, strengthen its fit for scalable automation in highly regulated environments.
- **Generative AI (GenAI) solution blueprinting:** Pega Blueprint uses GenAI to turn natural-language requirements and legacy assets into application and process designs. Buyers can accelerate discovery and solution design, reducing manual effort and time required to modernize and automate complex processes.
- **AI agent pricing:** Pega's AI Agent pricing strategy involves process-based pricing in lieu of token-based pricing, promising zero token cost. Its deterministic-first approach shifts much AI work to design time, helping buyers reduce exposure to unpredictable token

consumption and better forecast automation costs. Gartner has not yet validated the impacts with Pega's customers, as the offering is relatively new.

Cautions

- **Developer experience:** Pega development spans proprietary studios, with traditional automation and newer AI capabilities not yet fully unified. Limited bring-your-own-IDE support can constrain use of familiar IDEs and coding assistants, increasing onboarding friction for software engineering teams.
- **Deployment complexity:** Large Pega transformations can require substantial architecture, configuration and implementation expertise. Massive IT deployments can frequently take up to 12 months to close. Buyers using Pega to deploy complex enterprisewide automation should account for longer deployment cycles and partner dependency, which can increase cost and delay time to value.
- **Skills and cost commitment:** Pega's breadth and sophistication can require dedicated resources with specialized skills and significant platform investment. Buyers should assess availability of Pega expertise and total cost as adoption scales, as dependence on specialized resources can make Pega less economical for simpler automation workloads.

Salesforce

Salesforce is a Visionary in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers and has a global presence. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and retail.

Salesforce's BOAT is the Agentforce 360 Platform, which combines declarative workflows, integration and AI agents in an agentic operating layer governed by the Atlas Reasoning Engine. Top features include Headless 360 for deploying capabilities via MCP, Agentforce Builder and Agent Fabric as a multiplatform agent control plane.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of workflow-directed coordination for hierarchical brokers, enhancements to the external catalog tool for agent registries and expanded autonomous Computer Use Agents.

Strengths

- **Headless strategy:** The vendor offers a programmable headless architecture to orchestrate IT workflows. A dedicated agent fabric coordinates multivendor AI operations across

platforms. This visionary approach exposes capabilities as MCP tools to successfully prevent isolated AI execution silos.

- **AI agent innovation:** Salesforce continues to invest heavily in Agentforce. Organizations pursuing AI-assisted customer service and sales automation benefit from rapid product innovation integrated directly into CRM workflows.
- **AI agent control plane:** The platform delivers a centralized registry and control gateway for all native and external AI agents. It securely enforces strict role-based access, data masking and audit logging on every interaction. This rigorous compliance posture empowers regulated enterprise IT.

Cautions

- **Platform and licensing complexity:** Salesforce delivers its BOAT across multiple products, including Agentforce, MuleSoft, Data 360 and acquired technologies. Despite all the promise of a consolidated “Agentforce 360” vision, managing an enterprise deployment requires administrators to context-switch between Salesforce Setup (for core platform), Agent Fabric, Agentforce Marketing, Data 360 Setup and Agentforce Studio.
- **Data and governance prerequisites:** Agentforce relies heavily on trusted data, metadata, permissions and business context for grounded agent execution. Buyers with fragmented data or identity controls may require substantial cleansing and governance work before scaling agents, increasing implementation effort and time to value.
- **Discontinuation of native RPA:** Salesforce has officially removed native RPA capabilities (MuleSoft RPA) from its purchase catalog. For enterprise clients seeking to orchestrate end-to-end workflows that involve legacy Windows, Citrix or mainframe applications that lack modern APIs, this omission is a notable limitation. Customers need to separately license and integrate third-party RPA products to perform desktop UI-based automation, introducing added procurement friction.

SAP

SAP is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers with a global customer base. Its top industries are manufacturing, consumer industries and financial services.

SAP's BOAT is made up of various elements of the SAP Business AI Platform, which combines workflows, integrations, RPA, document automation, AI agents and application development in an integrated, governed cloud fabric. Top features include Joule Studio for agent and workflow authoring and SAP Integration Suite for enterprise connectivity.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of closed-loop process intelligence for automated optimization, a unified policy fabric across APIs and agent registries, and grounding for domain agents that incorporates business semantics and broader enterprise and process context.

Strengths

- **Overall viability:** SAP's scale, installed base and enterprise relationships provide buyers confidence in its ability to sustain long-term investment in automation. This reduces supplier risk.
- **Agentic governance:** SAP demonstrates a strong vision for agentic governance, including agent discovery, inventory management, verification workflows, tracing and identity management. SAP's LeanIX acquisition further strengthens its offering around AI governance.
- **SAP ecosystem:** SAP can embed automation, integration and AI directly into SAP-centric business processes and data. Buyers with large SAP estates can reduce integration effort and leverage existing business context, making SAP particularly relevant for automating processes spanning SAP applications.

Cautions

- **Agent interoperability:** SAP's API policy restricts use of SAP APIs with autonomous, semiautonomous or GenAI systems that plan or execute sequences of API calls, except through SAP-permitted architectures and pathways. Buyers planning third-party agentic automation across SAP applications should assess the architectural and governance implications.
- **BOAT fragmentation:** SAP's BOAT capabilities span Joule Studio, SAP Build, SAP Integration Suite, SAP Signavio and SAP LeanIX. Visual multiagent orchestration also uses n8n embedded within Joule Studio. Buyers should assess the operational coherence and maturity of this evolving architecture for end-to-end orchestration across processes, integrations and agents.

- **Orchestration maturity:** SAP provides both SAP and third-party connectivity, but its broader heterogeneous orchestration capabilities are still maturing. Buyers requiring sophisticated case management or complex multiagent orchestration should validate functional depth; for example, Joule subagents currently execute sequentially, rather than in parallel, and have composition limits.

ServiceNow

ServiceNow is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers and a global presence. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and the public sector.

ServiceNow's BOAT is the ServiceNow AI Platform, which combines workflows, APIs, RPA, AI agents and human tasks in a single runtime. Top features include AI Control Tower for governance, Action Fabric with MCP Registry for multivendor agents and Workflow Data Fabric for enterprise connectivity.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of security and risk AI specialists and native BPMN and DMN support.

Strengths

- **AI agent control plane vision:** ServiceNow delivers a forward-looking AI control tower to govern multivendor agent ecosystems. This gateway enforces compliance policies natively across internal and external MCP agents. Action Fabric and MCP support extend interoperability, helping buyers govern heterogeneous agent ecosystems without requiring all agents to be built on ServiceNow.
- **Enterprise workflow and governance:** ServiceNow combines enterprise workflow automation with common security, governance and life cycle controls. Buyers can standardize processes across IT and business functions while managing workflows and AI-powered automation on a shared operational platform.
- **ServiceNow ecosystem:** ServiceNow benefits from a broad global implementation ecosystem and strong executive adoption within enterprise IT organizations. Existing customers can often expand automation initiatives using established platform governance and implementation expertise.

Cautions

- **BOAT adoption:** ServiceNow shows relatively less customer evidence of enterprisewide process automation adoption than some BOAT peers. Its deployments often remain concentrated in IT, HR, procurement and selected adjacent workflows. Most customers in Gartner interactions either start with an IT service management focus or plan to expand to adjacent business workflow areas. Buyers seeking an enterprisewide BOAT platform should validate proven adoption across diverse business functions.
- **Commercial complexity:** ServiceNow combines subscription licensing with usage-based AI consumption. It provides analytics to monitor Now Assist consumption and usage patterns. However, multiple entitlements, consumption metrics and negotiated pricing can make enterprisewide automation costs difficult to forecast. Buyers scaling workflows and agentic automation should model expected consumption and commercial terms carefully.
- **Process orchestration depth:** ServiceNow has expanded well beyond IT workflows, but its process orchestration depth varies across business domains especially for complex processes. Buyers automating specialized processes in areas such as finance, supply chain or industry operations should assess whether native capabilities meet requirements without extensive customization.

SS&C Blue Prism

SS&C Blue Prism is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers primarily in North America, Europe and Southeast Asia. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and public sector.

SS&C Blue Prism's BOAT is the SS&C Blue Prism Platform, which combines bots, human workflows, AI agents, systems and orchestration under a single governed control plane. Top features include an AI gateway, native RPA and a modular approach to process orchestration complexity.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of a single operational hub to monitor agentic workflows, advanced agents with built-in external connectivity and a comprehensive agent governance framework for execution.

Strengths

- **Enterprise automation heritage:** SS&C Blue Prism has extensive experience supporting enterprise automation programs in highly regulated industries, particularly financial services, banking and public sector. Organizations modernizing established RPA

environments can leverage existing governance practices while extending automation into broader business orchestration initiatives.

- **Governance and operational control:** The platform emphasizes centralized governance, security and operational oversight across digital workers, AI capabilities and human activities. Organizations with stringent compliance and audit requirements may benefit from mature operational controls and life cycle management capabilities.
- **Customer stability:** As part of SS&C Technologies, the platform benefits from long-term investment, financial stability and established enterprise relationships. Existing SS&C customers may find opportunities to expand automation while leveraging broader enterprise software and services.

Cautions

- **Fragmented architecture:** The platform uses multiple orchestrators. WorkHQ orchestrates agentic workflows and digital workers, while Chorus is the traditional BPM orchestrator. AI policy enforcement, token tracking and governance are centrally managed through the separately licensed AI Gateway platform service.
- **Licensing:** Purchasing requires navigating varied commercial models across the portfolio, including consumption-based tiers for WorkHQ, per-user pricing for Chorus, per-bot licensing for digital workers and token-based fees for the AI Gateway.
- **Agentic capabilities:** SS&C Blue Prism's Agentic Workflows became generally available only in early 2026. The platform does not yet support third-party MCP servers or Agent2Agent interoperability with external agents. Buyers planning large-scale agent orchestration should validate production references, operational maturity, interoperability and scalability.

UiPath

UiPath is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a public company serving a broad range of customers and strong presences globally. Its top industries are financial services, healthcare and the public sector.

UiPath's BOAT is the UiPath Platform, which combines agents, robots, APIs, systems, documents and humans through a unified enterprise orchestration fabric. Top features include Maestro for long-running process orchestration, agentic case management and multiagent

coordination, Autopilot for AI-assisted development, and the AI Trust Layer for secure model endpoints.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of Maestro enhancements for human-in-the-loop multiagent orchestration and expanded GenAI-powered app generation.

Strengths

- **Innovation:** UiPath has rapidly expanded beyond RPA into IDP, process intelligence and testing, and is now extending this track record to business orchestration and automation. Buyers benefit from rapid innovation spanning agents, computer use, MCP and orchestration while building on existing automation investments.
- **UiPath ecosystem:** UiPath has a large enterprise customer base supported by an extensive global ecosystem of implementation partners, technology alliances and trained practitioners. Organizations can leverage mature deployment expertise, community resources and broad availability of automation skills.
- **Durable process execution:** UiPath's Maestro orchestration engine persists process state for long-running work, guarantees that each step executes once and can pause, rewind, replay and migrate a running process at runtime. Buyers can run processes lasting weeks, months or years that survive external infrastructure failure, version changes and workflow changes without losing state or restarting completed work.

Cautions

- **Complex process orchestration:** UiPath's process orchestration capabilities continue to mature relative to other BPA heritage vendors' longer-established offerings. While Maestro supports long-running workflows and human and agent orchestration, some advanced process constructs and execution semantics remain unsupported. Buyers with highly complex, exception-heavy or long-running business processes should validate required orchestration patterns, life cycle management and exception handling through proofs of concept.
- **Pricing:** UiPath's broad portfolio and multiple licensing models can make solution sizing, cost forecasting and contract evaluation challenging. Gartner clients have reported concerns about complex product packaging and commercial negotiations. Organizations should establish strong procurement and vendor management practices to ensure that

purchased capabilities align with business requirements and long-term budget expectations.

- **BOAT adoption:** UiPath's installed base and customer expertise still remain deeply rooted in RPA, while its positioning now spans process, agentic and enterprise orchestration. Buyers expanding UiPath into a BOAT may need to evolve governance, operating models and skills of internal UiPath support resources beyond established RPA practices.

Workato

Workato is a Visionary in this Magic Quadrant. It is a private company serving a broad range of customers primarily in North America, EMEA and APAC. Its top industries are technology, financial services and retail.

Workato's BOAT solution is the Workato ONE platform, which converges integration, API management, workflow orchestration, AI-assisted development and agentic AI capabilities onto a single cloud-native runtime. Key components include Workato AIRO, which functions as an enterprise AI and vibe-coding assistant to support automation development; Enterprise MCP, which provides a governed control plane for agent connectivity and interoperability; and Agent Studio, which enables organizations to author, deploy and manage autonomous AI agents.

The vendor's BOAT roadmap for the next year includes general availability of industry-specific genies for targeted verticals, an on-premises AI gateway for legacy applications and an air-gapped private instance for regulated environments.

Strengths

- **Product strategy:** Workato combines integration, workflow, AI agent orchestration and automation on a cloud-native platform with broad SaaS connectivity and reusable recipes. Buyers can rapidly build and orchestrate cross-application automations, reducing handoffs between separate integration platform as a service (iPaaS) and workflow tools.
- **Agent interoperability:** Workato distinguishes its platform through a mature enterprise MCP architecture that acts as a unified control plane, governing interoperability between heterogeneous AI agents and over 14,000 enterprise applications. By equipping this architecture with a centralized policy gateway and native registry, the vendor allows organizations to scale multiagent automation safely while strictly enforcing authorization, rate limiting and auditability across their entire AI ecosystem.

- **Workato connector ecosystem:** Workato combines AI-assisted development with an extensive ecosystem of connectors, reusable recipes, prebuilt agents, MCP servers and SaaS partnerships. Buyers can accelerate common automation use cases and reuse existing integrations, reducing development effort and time to value across cloud-centric environments.

Cautions

- **Process orchestration:** Workato supports long-running workflows, but customer adoption evidence shows that its orchestration capabilities are primarily optimized around simple to moderate complexity automation. Buyers with highly stateful, human-intensive or exception-heavy processes should validate its ability to manage process state, recovery and complex execution paths at scale.
- **BOAT adoption:** Workato has highly satisfied customers and credible installed-base advocacy, but broader BOAT mindshare and adoption proof points are still emerging. Buyers should assess its breadth and customer evidence for consolidating diverse automation workloads onto a common platform.
- **Add-on cost:** Workato's core consumption pricing does not include all advanced platform capabilities. Some governance, security controls, private cloud and secure vault capabilities require separately priced packages. Typical buyers may not need to purchase these services, but buyers scaling BOAT enterprisewide should assess the full configuration required to avoid unplanned incremental costs.

Vendors Added and Dropped

We review and adjust our inclusion criteria for Magic Quadrants as markets change. As a result of these adjustments, the mix of vendors in any Magic Quadrant may change over time. A vendor's appearance in a Magic Quadrant one year and not the next does not necessarily indicate that we have changed our opinion of that vendor. It may be a reflection of a change in the market and, therefore, changed evaluation criteria, or of a change of focus by that vendor.

Added

- Amazon Web Services
- n8n

Dropped

- Hyland
- Newgen

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

In addition to Gartner client relevance, as determined by analyst expertise and opinion, providers had to meet all the criteria for sections A, B, C and D to qualify for inclusion.

A. Market Definition and Product Qualification

The vendor's product must meet Gartner's definition of business orchestration and automation technologies and support the critical capabilities defined for the market.

Specifically, the product must:

- Support processes with varying degrees of autonomy, from deterministic to nondeterministic automation.
- Support processes with varying levels of complexity, including short-running, long-running, exception-driven and cross-functional processes.
- Operate across multiple enterprise applications, data sources and execution environments, rather than within a single application boundary.
- Be relevant to enterprisewide process automation and orchestration, not just task automation, content services or workflow routing.

B. Product Capabilities

Vendors must offer the following within their BOAT platform or product as of 31 March 2026:

- Function as the primary orchestration control plane across multiple enterprise systems and execution environments.
- Support long-running multi-step processes with persistent state.
- Coordinate execution across multiple systems of record and systems of engagement.

- Orchestrate human tasks, APIs, bots and AI agents within a single end-to-end process model.
- Offer native capabilities for AI agent building, orchestration and governance including observability and auditability.
- Support orchestration where multiple AI agents contribute to a business outcome under a managed control layer.
- Support sequential agent coordination, parallel agent execution, supervisory orchestration, iterative or loop-based refinement and agent-to-agent handoff.
- Support human-in-the-loop orchestration as a first-class capability.
- Support API-based integration, event-based orchestration patterns, native UI-based interactions and emerging connectivity models such as Model Context Protocol, Agent to Agent and Agent Network Protocol where relevant.

C. Go-to-Market Focus

- Have a named platform offering BOAT capabilities that can be directly sold to customers. The evaluated product must also be positioned, sold, marketed by the vendor as a primary enterprise business orchestration and automation platform.
- Not as secondary workflow functionality embedded within another primary product category (e.g., content services, document management, CRM, iPaaS, LCAP, RPA, system orchestration, SOAP, etc).

D. Market Momentum and Ecosystem Strength

- The provider must demonstrate either:
 - A minimum threshold of 300 unique paying customers (logos) for the evaluated product or the BOAT market.
 - Or an overall minimum of total 10,000 unique paying customer logos
 - Or minimum year-over-year growth in related product revenue/ARR (e.g., BOAT) of 45%
- The provider must demonstrate at least 20 identifiable system integration or implementation partners. (Named SI, consulting or implementation partners with delivery

capability. A services ecosystem sufficient to support customers beyond direct vendor professional services.)

- The provider must demonstrate customer adoption across at least two industries.
- The provider must also demonstrate customer or delivery presence across at least two major geographic regions among North America, EMEA, APAC and Latin America.

Customer evidence should reflect usage relevant to BOAT capabilities, not unrelated adjacent products only.

We excluded vendors that:

- Had open-source platforms supporting core capabilities of BOAT via API integrations with other third-party products (or other BOATs).
- Had orchestration-only platforms lacking broader connectivity focus, low-code and agentic AI focus.
- Only sold their BOAT product as licensed software along with development/professional services, where the product was used exclusively by the vendor's consultants/service providers.
- Did not offer a commercial enterprise BOAT offering (that is, they offered a platform only as open-source software or a free community version).
- Would retire their BOAT platform by the end of 2026.
- Did not have a generally available BOAT platform as of 31 January 2026.

Evaluation Criteria

Ability to Execute

Product or Service: Gartner specifically looked for (1) the breadth and depth of a vendor's BOAT platform; (2) cohesiveness of the platform and how integrated all capabilities are; and (3) depth of certain capabilities such as orchestration, connectivity and agentic automation.

Overall Viability: Gartner specifically looked for (1) overall sentiment about the vendor from the BOAT perspective (market, customer, investor); (2) net BOAT sales pipeline and depth of

sales capability; and (3) operational strength in BOAT (investment in sales, marketing, product, innovation, engineering, support), global presence and number of employees.

Sales Execution/Pricing: Gartner specifically looked for (1) BOAT sales volume, pipeline and overall execution strength; (2) BOAT pricing clarity, flexibility and value for price; and (3) BOAT revenue, market share and growth.

Market Responsiveness and Track Record: Gartner specifically looked for (1) number of BOAT releases per year; (2) evidence of listening to the voice of the customer and a good short-term roadmap; and (3) overall upgrade quality, all from a BOAT perspective.

Marketing Execution: Gartner specifically looked for (1) effort from the vendor to make itself visible in the BOAT market (web, social media, print media, marketing narrative); (2) clarity of go-to-market messaging; and (3) brand awareness, market relevance and customer community strength.

Customer Experience: Gartner specifically looked for (1) customer satisfaction/feedback; (2) support focus and maturity; and (3) overall training, support and upgrade focus.

Operations: Gartner specifically looked for (1) number of employees supporting BOAT; (2) investment in product, marketing, sales, support and innovation labs; and (3) global presence, number of offices and developer community strength.

Ability to Execute Evaluation Criteria	
Evaluation Criteria	Weighting
Product or Service	High
Overall Viability	High
Sales Execution/Pricing	High
Market Responsiveness/Record	Low
Marketing Execution	High

<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Customer Experience	Medium
Operations	High

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Completeness of Vision

Marketing Strategy: Gartner specifically looked for (1) product vision alignment to BOAT; (2) product clarity and number of native capabilities supported; and (3) market influence on BOAT.

Sales Strategy: Gartner specifically looked for (1) clear future product and market strategy for BOAT; (2) pipeline strength; and (3) effort to ramp up partner ecosystem.

Offering (Product) Strategy: Gartner specifically looked for (1) clarity of BOAT platform — number of products required to support BOAT; (2) number of native capabilities; and (3) cohesiveness of product UX and ability to offer great quality and depth for key capabilities with a clearly defined roadmap.

Business Model: Gartner specifically looked for (1) core market differentiation in narrative and demonstrated behavior; (2) vendor maturity; and (3) clear future product and market strategy on BOAT, including thought leadership.

Vertical Strategy: Gartner specifically looked for (1) number of verticals supported; (2) vertical-specific prebuilt components (bots, agents, templates); and (3) vertical depth (quality of prebuilt assets) and maturity.

Geographic Strategy: Gartner specifically looked for (1) number of regions supported; (2) specific geographic focus vs. global market reach for BOAT; and (3) sales, support, data center and customer base in different geographic locations.

Completeness of Vision Evaluation Criteria

<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Market Understanding	High
Marketing Strategy	High
Sales Strategy	High
Offering (Product) Strategy	High
Business Model	High
Vertical/Industry Strategy	Medium
Innovation	High
Geographic Strategy	Low

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Quadrant Descriptions

Leaders

Leaders have a record of strong execution and an ability to influence the market’s direction. Leaders tend to have a strong vision and market understanding, especially around end-to-end business process orchestration. They typically support enterprise-grade process orchestration, robust connectivity and leading-edge agentic automation capabilities.

Their platforms are cohesive and functionally rich, and there are regular releases to rapidly address the needs of this fast-evolving market. They have a clear product roadmap to solidify the product’s position and to help buyers protect their investments. They have a large network of partners that provide localized support and services to customers across most geographic regions.

Leaders are well-positioned to remain dominant as the BOAT market evolves. However, their status cannot be taken for granted. In the fast-moving BOAT market, vendors that lose focus will move out of the Leaders quadrant.

Challengers

Challengers offer competitive platforms that deliver value in multiple process automation scenarios but may be limited to certain industries or use cases, or focused on a specific domain. Challengers demonstrate the financial strength and commitment to compete in the BOAT market.

Challengers generally execute the types of work for which they offer certain functionality well, but have a lagging or incomplete view of the market's direction. Sometimes this is due to a lack of innovation in product, marketing and/or sales strategies or a narrow focus on a single application domain. They often have a narrower focus of who the buyers are, what the use cases are or how users' expectations will evolve. They may have a background in RPA, agentic AI, low-code development or enterprise process orchestration, or they may be just a component in a large vendor ecosystem and may currently lack visibility or credibility outside of their existing customer base or domain. As a result, their offerings have a more limited appeal than those of Leaders.

Challengers may lack a coordinated strategy for the various products in their platform portfolio, or their platform roadmap may be less complete or more fragmented than that of Leaders. Alternatively, they may lag behind Leaders in terms of marketing, sales channels, geographic presence, industry-specific content and innovation. To mature their offerings, Challengers must improve in their specific areas of caution and match Leaders' platform capabilities and roadmaps.

Visionaries

Visionaries demonstrate strong innovation with a good understanding of emerging technology and business trends. They understand the specific requirements of the market and align their BOAT capabilities with current demand by innovating their technologies, delivery models and go-to-market strategies. However, they may not have the sales and marketing expertise required to build awareness for their offerings and sell more widely. Typically, they lack strong process orchestration focus and/or native capabilities such as RPA, IDP or API connectivity.

Visionaries may have a background in traditional on-premises orchestration or connectivity tools or perhaps as cloud-native startups. They may see their BOAT offering as a key element of a broader orchestration and agentic strategy. They may branch out into providing features that support enterprise AI initiatives, hyperautomation use cases or application composition use cases by adding features for, respectively, AI agents, event-driven orchestration, or RPA or low-code application development.

To become Leaders, Visionaries must build stronger recognition of their platforms in new customer segments and drastically improve their sales strategy and execution to expand their market share.

Niche Players

Niche Players typically focus on one vertical, geographical or functional area, or only address a segment of the BOAT market, or may not even have all the capabilities as native and or unified within their platform. They may trail in broader market understanding and innovation because of less investment or focus or because they deliberately occupy a niche within the market. Typically, they lack strong process orchestration focus and/or native capabilities such as AI, RPA, IDP or API connectivity.

Niche Players may be startups or small companies, or even megavendors focused on a specific subset of use cases; or they may be vendors that provide a wide range of capabilities, but lack market understanding or focus for their products. They may even have a fragmented product portfolio with no clear vision to unify it. However, some of their individual technology offerings and degree of customer satisfaction within that segment may often be excellent.

Niche Players' offerings can be suitable for organizations that require local presence and support, want a close relationship with a provider, or seek a platform that addresses specific industry use cases and functional requirements. Niche Players that can fulfill these specific requirements may offset the viability risks associated with smaller vendors.

Niche Players can mature and refine their offerings by improving their marketing strategy and fostering innovation.

Context

Business orchestration and automation technologies have entered a period of rapid transformation as generative AI and agentic capabilities reshape enterprise automation strategies. Organizations are moving beyond isolated RPA, workflow, integration and low-code investments, toward platforms that can orchestrate people, applications, APIs, events and AI agents within a governed automation ecosystem.

No single vendor currently delivers best-in-class capabilities across every BOAT component. Therefore, platform selection should prioritize strategic fit, architectural alignment, governance maturity and ecosystem strength over individual AI features or marketing claims. Enterprises that establish a modular automation architecture while avoiding unnecessary platform sprawl will be better-positioned to scale agentic automation over the next several years.

Clients should use this research to:

- Rationalize existing automation investments and reduce platform sprawl before expanding AI and agentic automation initiatives.
- Select BOAT platforms based on long-term orchestration strategy, governance, interoperability and architectural fit rather than individual AI features.
- Prioritize vendors that can orchestrate workflows, APIs, events, people and AI agents through a unified operating model.
- Adopt open, modular architectures that minimize vendor lock-in while enabling the incremental adoption of emerging AI and agent interoperability capabilities.
- Establish a phased modernization roadmap that strengthens governance, observability and human oversight while evolving legacy automation toward agentic automation.

Market Overview

Business orchestration and automation technologies (BOAT) are consolidated software platforms that orchestrate and automate disparate business processes and tasks with varying degrees of autonomy and complexity across enterprise systems. Gartner estimates that the BOAT market could exceed \$34 billion by 2030, as organizations prioritize platforms capable of orchestrating hybrid automation environments and operationalizing AI-driven automation

(see [Forecasting the \\$34 Billion Opportunity in Business Orchestration and Automation Technologies](#)).

The BOAT market is rapidly evolving as enterprise automation shifts from fragmented task automation toward unified orchestration of processes, systems, humans and AI agents. Earlier approaches based on RPA, scripts and workflow engines delivered productivity gains but often created disconnected automation environments that were difficult to govern, integrate and scale. BOAT platforms address this fragmentation by providing a unified automation platform that orchestrates work across APIs, applications, bots, humans and AI agents while supporting deterministic workflows, event-driven integrations and nondeterministic agentic automation. As AI agents take on more complex enterprise tasks, BOAT platforms are increasingly positioned as an enterprise control plane for agentic automation, providing the orchestration, connectivity, observability and policy controls needed to govern how agents interact with enterprise systems, workflows and data safely and reliably at scale.

For more information, see [Market Overview for Business Orchestration and Automation Technologies](#).

The following five trends and market dynamics define the current state and outlook for BOAT.

Automation stacks continue to converge

Historically separate markets — such as RPA, workflow automation, integration platforms, process orchestration and document-centric automation — are converging. Vendors are responding by building broader platforms that combine orchestration, connectivity, AI capabilities and operational controls in one environment.

Business process orchestration is at the core

BOAT ensures that future automation strategies will still have robust business process orchestration at their core, avoiding silos and fragmentation. As orchestration shifts to autonomous execution, BOAT embeds governance, transparency and compliance at every decision point, safeguarding trust in the future of automation.

Agentic automation is becoming operationalized

Organizations are moving from experimentation with copilots and isolated agents toward governed deployment inside business processes. BOAT platforms are becoming the

mechanism for embedding agents into orchestrated workflows with defined roles, guardrails and escalation paths.

Control-plane capabilities are becoming a buying priority

As AI agents interact with more systems and decisions, buyers increasingly require centralized policy enforcement, observability, life cycle management, auditability and resilience. This shifts platform evaluation from feature checklists toward architectural control and production readiness.

BOAT will be the orchestrator of AI agents from multiple vendors

Enterprises will soon deploy hundreds or thousands of specialized AI agents, creating a complication where these uncoordinated agents operate in silos and create operational chaos. BOAT platforms are therefore evolving into the essential “execution brain,” providing the central orchestration needed to coordinate, sequence and govern these multiagent systems within a business process. By supporting agent interoperability and embedding agents into workflows, BOAT enables enterprises to build and scale reliable autonomous operations.

Acronym Key and Glossary Terms

A2A	Agent2Agent
BOAT	Business orchestration and automation technologies
BFSI	Banking, financial services and insurance
BPA	Business process automation
BPMN	Business Process Model and Notation
DMN	Decision Model Notation

iPaaS	Integration platform as a service
MCP	Model Context Protocol
RPA	Robotic process automation

⊕ Evaluation Criteria Definitions

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